# Aalto slides — cheat sheet

Typst + Touying · Aalto visual identity · plain text → PDF in 0.5 s · typst ≥ 0.15 · full guides: `docs/using-the-template.md` (the tool) and `docs/making-a-talk.md` (how to build a talk)

## Build & run

| | |
|---|---|
| `demo` | build the demo deck → `demo/demo.pdf` |
| `watch-demo` | rebuild the demo on every save |
| `new` | `new my-talk` → scaffold `decks/my-talk/` from the template |
| `deck` | `deck my-talk` → build `decks/my-talk/main.pdf` |
| `watch-deck` | `watch-deck my-talk` → edit with a live rebuild |
| `cheatsheet` | this page → `docs/cheatsheet.pdf` |
| `clean` | remove built PDFs (sources stay) |

Run them as `./slides demo` (or `make demo`, `make new NAME=…`). VS Code + Tinymist gives a preview instead — point its root at the template folder.

## One deck = a few files

```
decks/my-talk/
  main.typ              identity: title, author,
                        accent, colour, logo
  sections/01-intro.typ your slides (one file
                        per talk section)
  figures/              what you reference
```

Every section file starts with the import — `#include` does not inherit imports:

```
#import "../../../theme/aalto.typ": *
```

## The language, in six lines

```
= Section          // colour section slide
== Slide title     // a content slide
=== Subheading     // bold grey, in a slide
// comment
#cmd(...)          // `#` starts a command
[content]          // brackets = content
```

`- bullet` · `+ numbered` · a blank line starts a new paragraph.

## Slide recipes

**Bullets and emphasis**

```
== The coating cracks above 700 °C

- one idea per bullet, ≤ 6 bullets
- *bold*, `code`, $x^2 + y^2 = z^2$
- #alert[accent, readable on white]
```

**Text beside a figure**

```
#two-col(ratio: (3fr, 2fr))[
  - the plateau above 700 °C
  - the error bars
][
  #figure(image("figures/tga.svg",
    width: 100%),
    caption: [TGA trace, batch 3.])
]
```

**Figure not ready yet**

```
#figure-placeholder(
  label: [AFM height image],
  ratio: 16/10)
```

**One big claim**

```
#focus-slide[40 % less
  delamination.]
```

**Reveal as you speak**

```
- first point
#pause
- second, after you click
#gray-in[dim → full]
#gray-out[full → dim]
```

**Tables, code, maths — all native**

Tables with `#table(columns: 3, [a], [b], [c])`, fenced code blocks, and maths in `$ integral_0^inf e^(-x^2) dif x = sqrt(pi)/2 $`.

**Free layout**

```
#place(top + right,
  image("x.png", height: 2em))
#grid(columns: 2, column-gutter: 1em, a, b)
```

**Notes, opening, closing**

```
#speaker-note[Ask about the ramp rate.]

#title-slide(dark: true, logo:
  "/assets/logo/tertiary/aalto-fi-se-en-\
   white-quote.pdf")

#thanks-slide(word: [Kiitos!],
  contact: ("Name · group",
            "you@aalto.fi"))
```

## Theme knobs

All in `#show: aalto-theme.with(…)` in `main.typ`. Everything is sized relative to one base, so `density` rescales the whole deck — avoid hand-set font sizes.

| | |
|---|---|
| `accent` | `aalto-blue` · `aalto-red` · `aalto-yellow` · `school-colours.sci` / `.chem` / `.eng` / `.elec` / `.biz` / `.arts` — one school per deck, never mixed |
| `density` | `roomy` `default` `compact` `dense` = 24/20/17/15 pt base. Hall or bad projector → `roomy`; methods detail → `compact`; `dense` is for handouts, not screens |
| `scale` | `0.9` — one notch below a preset |
| `mark` | `"question"` `"quote"` `"exclaim"` — forces the logomark (A? A“ A!) on every slide, title to closing |
| `corner` | `"mark"` (default: bare logomark bottom-left) · `"primary"` brings the wordmark back · `"keep"` |
| `logo` | a **path string**, not `image()`: `"/assets/logo/primary/aalto-black-quote.pdf"` |
| `short-title` | shows bottom-left next to the logo; omit for a clean footer |
| `aspect-ratio` | `"16-9"` (default), `"4-3"` |
| `header/ footer` | functions for the small decorations |

## Logos

```
python3 assets/logo/fetch-logos.py
  # 30 official originals (university)
python3 assets/logo/make-plain.py
  # + the text-free logomark
python3 assets/logo/measure-logos.py
  # regenerate theme/logo-metrics.typ
python3 assets/logo/fetch-logos.py \
  --unit sci --unit chem
```

Names: `<lockup>/aalto-<lang-><colour>-<mark>.pdf` — lockups **primary** (mark + name below), **secondary** (trilingual, 3 rows), **tertiary** (trilingual, right — title slides), **mark** (no text: corners, closing). Black on light, white on dark; official originals only, never redrawn. Pass a **path** and the theme sizes the visible logo and aligns its ink to the margin, because the files carry Aalto's clear space inside them.

## Presenting

- `pdfpc decks/my-talk/main.pdf` — notes, next slide, timer, dual screen
- present from the **exported PDF**, not a live build; name it `talk-2026-11-05.pdf`, put it on a stick **and** in your outbox
- check the room: beam projectors wash out light colours; never yellow on white
- 3–5 back-pocket answer slides **after** the thank-you

## Before you present

- ☐ titles alone read as an argument
- ☐ squint / 25 %-zoom test passed
- ☐ figures labelled, sources cited
- ☐ `#pause` matches what you say
- ☐ preliminary data marked as such
- ☐ rehearsed aloud, with a timer
- ☐ PDF exported, named, on a stick

## Troubleshooting

`path would escape the project root` → use `/assets/…` root paths, or build from the template folder
`unknown variable: x` → missing `#import` line in that section file
`file not found (…/assets/logo/…)` → typo, or run `fetch-logos.py`
logo tiny or floating → not in `theme/logo-metrics.typ`: run `measure-logos.py`
content vanished → a `#pause` inside a heading, or nested in a grid cell
first build fails offline → Touying downloads once; preview differs in VS Code → set Tinymist's root to the template folder

Brand rules the theme enforces: Inter everywhere · bold tight-tracked headings · sentence case · left-aligned ragged-right · ≤ 3 type sizes per surface · brand colours take **black** text (≥ 7:1) · one school colour per deck · logo originals only.
Offline brand mirror (maintainer's local): `reference/brand-aalto-fi/` · brand.aalto.fi · typst.app/docs · touying.app · aaltologo.fi